

BEYOND THE CREST

The Donohue Company — Document 03

A Daytime Drama

Founded: Monday, April 3, 1939, Atlanta, Georgia

Founder: Alexander Donohue (b. Friday, March 3, 1916)

Valuation: \$10 trillion

Corporate Profile

Field	Detail
Legal name	The Donohue Company
Ticker	NYSE: DNHU (Class A common)
Control	The Donohue family, through super-voting Class B shares held directly by family trusts
Industry	Multinational mass media & entertainment conglomerate
Headquarters	Donohue Tower, 1939 Peachtree Street NE, Midtown Atlanta, GA 30309
Founder	Alexander Donohue (1916–2006), with Simone Donohue (1920–2014)
Chairman	Victor Donohue (2006–present)
CEO	Natasha Bullock (2006–present)
President & COO	Marc-Anthony Bullock (named Mon, Jan 5, 2026)
Market capitalization	\$10.0 trillion (world's most valuable company)
Annual revenue (FY2025)	\$1.62 trillion
Net income (FY2025)	\$318 billion
Employees	1.14 million in 96 countries
Audience reach	Some Donohue product touches an estimated 6.1 billion people a month
Philanthropy	The Donohue Foundation (endowment \$300 billion+), chaired by Joan Donohue. It spares no expense.

The Founder

Alexander Donohue was born on Friday, March 3, 1916, above a barbershop on Auburn Avenue, “Sweet Auburn,” then the richest Black street in America. His father was a Pullman porter who brought home every newspaper left behind on the trains. His mother took in laundry and read those papers aloud at night. By 12, Alexander was selling newspapers on street corners, and he noticed that none of the papers he sold told his neighbors' stories. By 20 he was setting type at a Black-owned print shop. At 23 he started his own paper.

He met **Simone Batiste**, a New Orleans jazz singer four years his junior, when she played the Top Hat Club on Auburn Avenue in 1938. She had been singing in clubs since she was 14, and she bankrolled the first printing press with her savings. They married on Saturday, June 7, 1941. Alexander called her “my first investor and my only partner,” and meant it.

History of The Donohue Company

1939–1949: The Beacon

- Monday, April 3, 1939: *The Atlanta Beacon* publishes its first edition, four pages printed on Simone's press in a back room on Auburn Avenue. Circulation: 1,100.
- 1942–1945: The Beacon sends Black war correspondents to Europe and the Pacific. Circulation passes 200,000, and “The Beacon” becomes the most trusted Black newspaper in the South.
- 1947: Launches *Crown*, a Black lifestyle and society magazine.

1950–1959: Radio, Records & Pictures

- 1951: Donohue buys WDON-AM, putting Black voices on Atlanta radio: gospel on Sunday, jazz on Friday, the news every hour.
- 1953: **Donohue Pictures** is founded, first to make films for Black audiences and then to break them into white theaters.
- 1958: Alexander and Simone found Belmont Crest (see Document 04).
- 1959: Donohue Pictures' *Sweet Auburn Serenade* becomes the first Black-produced film to top the national box office.

1960–1975: The Movement Years

- 1961: **Donohue Records** launches in Atlanta: soul, gospel, and the sound of the South. It becomes Motown's great Southern rival.
- 1960s: The Beacon covers the civil rights movement from the inside. Alexander quietly bankrolls bail funds and bus fare, and the FBI opens a file on him in 1963.
- 1966: Victor Donohue, 20, becomes a matinee idol in *Midnight on Peachtree*.
- 1969: Victor marries his co-star Joan Mercer, and the company's first family becomes America's first family of entertainment.
- 1972: Launches WDON-TV, a UHF station, the seed of **Donohue Broadcasting Group**. Victor originates the lead in the Broadway musical *Sweet Chariot*.

1976–1989: Victor's Empire

- Monday, January 5, 1976: Alexander names his younger son Victor CEO over his elder son Theodore and becomes Chairman. Theodore walks out of the boardroom and doesn't come back.
- Monday, October 16, 1978: **IPO** on the New York Stock Exchange. The Donohue Company lists Class A shares and keeps super-voting Class B shares in the family.
- 1981: Launches the **Crown Network**, a 24-hour cable channel, and starts buying stations in 30 markets.
- 1987: A hostile takeover of Paragon Pictures, a century-old Hollywood studio. The trade press calls it “the Atlanta Invasion.”

1990–2005: Going Global

- 1990: Signs the first **Crown License** with Smilley Corporation, the master licensing deal that puts Donohue characters and brands on Smilley products (see Document 06).
- 1995: Buys the Continental Broadcasting Company, a national broadcast network, and rebrands it **DBC**.

- 1998: Opens the first **Donohue Worlds** theme park in Orlando and takes a 4% strategic stake in Smilley Corporation.
- 2001: Launches Beacon News Network (BNN), a 24-hour global news channel.
- 2004: Acquires Crown Comics and its universe of heroes.

2006–2019: The Natasha Era

- Monday, January 9, 2006: Alexander Donohue dies at 89. Victor becomes Chairman and Natasha becomes CEO at 34.
- 2009: Donohue Games is founded; its *Kingdom of Kora* franchise becomes the best-selling game series of the decade.
- 2012: The Donohue Company takes a 12% strategic stake in Blackwater Security International (see Document 05).
- 2016: **Donohue+** streaming launches worldwide and reaches 100 million subscribers in 14 months.
- 2018: Donohue Worlds opens in Tokyo, Paris, and Dubai.
- 2019: Market capitalization passes \$1 trillion for the first time.

2020–2026: The \$10 Trillion Company

- 2020: Donohue+ passes 500 million subscribers during the pandemic, and Donohue Live pioneers virtual concerts and Broadway streams.
- 2021: Donohue Studios AI launches, with the **Donohue Creator Guarantee**: every AI tool pays human artists royalties.
- 2023: Market cap passes \$5 trillion. Marc-Anthony wins his Oscar for a Donohue Pictures film.
- Wednesday, December 31, 2025: The stock closes at \$250 a share. Market cap: **\$10.0 trillion**.
- Monday, January 5, 2026: Series premiere. Victor's Succession Covenant names Marc-Anthony President & COO.

Divisions (2026)

Division	Leader	What it is
Donohue Pictures (incl. Paragon)	Natasha Bullock (oversight)	The world's No. 1 film studio
Donohue Broadcasting Group	Martin Olson, President	DBC network, the Crown Network, 212 local stations
Donohue+		Streaming, 1.3 billion subscribers
Donohue Records & Publishing		No. 1 music label and catalog
Beacon Media		<i>The Atlanta Beacon</i> , BNN news, <i>Crown</i> magazine, book publishing
Donohue Worlds		Theme parks, resorts, cruise line
Donohue Games		Games, esports, <i>Kingdom of Kora</i>

Division	Leader	What it is
Donohue Live		Concerts, Broadway (Donohue Theatricals), live events
Donohue Consumer Licensing	Reports to Marc-Anthony	Licenses Donohue IP worldwide. Home of the Crown License with Smilley
Donohue Studios AI		AI production tools under the Creator Guarantee
Crown Comics		Publisher of the Crown Universe of heroes

The Crown License and the Smilleys

Donohue Consumer Licensing sells Smilley Corporation the rights to put Donohue characters, films, and brands on toys, clothes, cosmetics, and home goods. That one agreement drives about **41% of Smilley revenue** and only about 0.6% of Donohue's. Donohue is also Smilley's largest outside shareholder. The current license expires at **11:59 PM on Monday, August 31, 2026**. That deadline drives Season 1.

Share Distribution: The Donohue Company (NYSE: DNHU)

The Donohue Company uses the same kind of **dual-class structure** that controls many real family media empires: the public owns most of the economic value, while the family keeps control through super-voting shares that family members hold directly through their personal trusts.

- **Class A common** (NYSE: DNHU): 1 vote per share, publicly traded.
- **Class B common**: 10 votes per share, not traded, held only by Donohue family members. Converts to Class A if sold outside the family.
- Shares outstanding: 40.0 billion at \$250.00 = \$10.0 trillion market cap.

Holder	Class B (bn)	Class A (bn)	Economic %	Voting %	Value
Victor Donohue (Victor Donohue Revocable Trust)	2.6	0.0	6.5%	23.2%	\$650B
Joan Donohue (Joan Mercer Donohue Trust)	1.4	0.2	4.0%	12.7%	\$400B
Natasha Bullock (Natasha Donohue Bullock Trust)	1.2	0.0	3.0%	10.7%	\$300B
Jasmine Olson (Jasmine Donohue Olson Trust)	1.2	0.0	3.0%	10.7%	\$300B
Alvin Donohue (Alvin Donohue Trust)	0.8	0.0	2.0%	7.1%	\$200B
Marc-Anthony Bullock (Dynasty Trust share)	0.8	0.0	2.0%	7.1%	\$200B
Theodore Donohue Family Trust	0.0	0.8	2.0%	0.7%	\$200B
Martin Olson (Dynasty Trust share)	0.0	0.4	1.0%	0.4%	\$100B
Elxa Jackson (Dynasty Trust share)	0.0	0.2	0.5%	0.2%	\$50B
Grace Bullock (Dynasty Trust share)	0.0	0.2	0.5%	0.2%	\$50B
Mallory Olson (Dynasty Trust share)	0.0	0.2	0.5%	0.2%	\$50B
Donohue family subtotal	8.0	2.0	25.0%	73.2%	\$2,500B
The Donohue Foundation	0.0	1.2	3.0%	1.1%	\$300B
Directors & officers (non-family)	0.0	0.2	0.5%	0.2%	\$50B
Employee stock plans (ESOP & 401k)	0.0	0.8	2.0%	0.7%	\$200B
Index & passive fund managers	0.0	9.6	24.0%	8.6%	\$2,400B
Active institutional investors	0.0	8.4	21.0%	7.5%	\$2,100B
Public pension funds	0.0	2.4	6.0%	2.1%	\$600B
Sovereign wealth funds	0.0	2.0	5.0%	1.8%	\$500B

Holder	Class B (bn)	Class A (bn)	Economic %	Voting %	Value
Retail & other public holders	0.0	5.4	13.5%	4.8%	\$1,350B
TOTAL	8.0	32.0	100%	100%	\$10,000B

RESULT: The family owns 25% of the company's value (\$2.5 trillion, the Donohue family fortune) and controls 73.2% of the vote.

Rules that drive the drama

- **The Crown Voting Agreement.** Signed by Alexander and his heirs at the 1978 IPO, it binds every Class B holder to vote as one bloc (71.4% of the company) as directed by the Chairman. Victor's own shares carry 23.2%, but through the Agreement he steers the whole bloc.
- **The Line of Succession.** If Victor ever steps down or retires, Natasha becomes Chairwoman and the CEO seat is left vacant for the board to fill. Marc-Anthony, as President & COO, is the obvious successor to the CEO seat. But this is a daytime soap opera, and nothing is guaranteed.
- **Section 7 of the Agreement.** The Chair directs the family's voting bloc. But if Victor dies in office instead of retiring, Section 7 hands direction of the bloc to the eldest child, Jasmine, and after her, Martin. That would leave Natasha in the Chair while her sister controls the votes that can remove her.
- **The 1976 Stripping.** When Victor was made CEO, Alexander converted Theodore's Class B shares into Class A: the branch kept the money and lost the vote. Theodore has contested it privately for fifty years.
- **The Dynasty Trust.** The third generation holds Class A shares only, except Marc-Anthony. On January 5, 2026, Victor gave him Class B shares, making him the first grandchild with a vote.
- **Alvin's children.** Any biological child of a Class B holder becomes a Dynasty Trust beneficiary. Every paternity claim against Alvin is a claim on the fortune.
- **Victor's 80th (Saturday, May 30, 2026).** Victor planned to announce his retirement that night, making Natasha Chairwoman, and to name his choice for CEO. He collapsed before he could say the name.

Net worth check (as of January 5, 2026)

Person	Donohue Co. shares	Other holdings	Approx. net worth
Victor Donohue	\$650B	Real estate, art, Broadway royalties	~\$680B
Joan Donohue	\$400B	Film royalties, jewels	~\$415B
Natasha Bullock	\$300B	CEO compensation, film & music royalties	~\$330B
Jasmine Olson	\$300B		~\$305B (with Peter's fortune, far more)
Marc-Anthony Bullock	\$200B	58% of BSI (\$754B), personal investments (\$40B+)	\$994B+, rising daily

Person	Donohue Co. shares	Other holdings	Approx. net worth
Martin Olson	\$100B		~\$104B